



Amazon Echo, Echo dot, tap and Fire TV are all powered by Alexa, the cloud based AI assistant

These devices, though not smart hubs, can be used to connect and interact with many smart devices and with regular updates coming from Amazon, the number of these devices are surely going to increase. But still it was never meant as a replacement for smart hubs. Instead it is supposed to work with them. Amazon Echo and the other devices are compatible with several smart hubs including Smart-Things, Wink Hub 2 and the Insteon 2245-222 hub.

Google Home

A portable speaker powered by Google's assistant, the recently launched Google Home is Amazon Echo's primary competitor. And just like it, it is no smart hub even though it comes with capabilities to connect to and control many smart devices including all Nest products (Nest is owned by Google). Google Assistant at least seems smarter than the Amazon's Alexa (all thanks to the search giant) but whether it can replace standalone smart hubs, is yet to be seen.



The recently launched portable speakers by Google, are powered by Google Assistant and come packed with a number of nifty home automation features